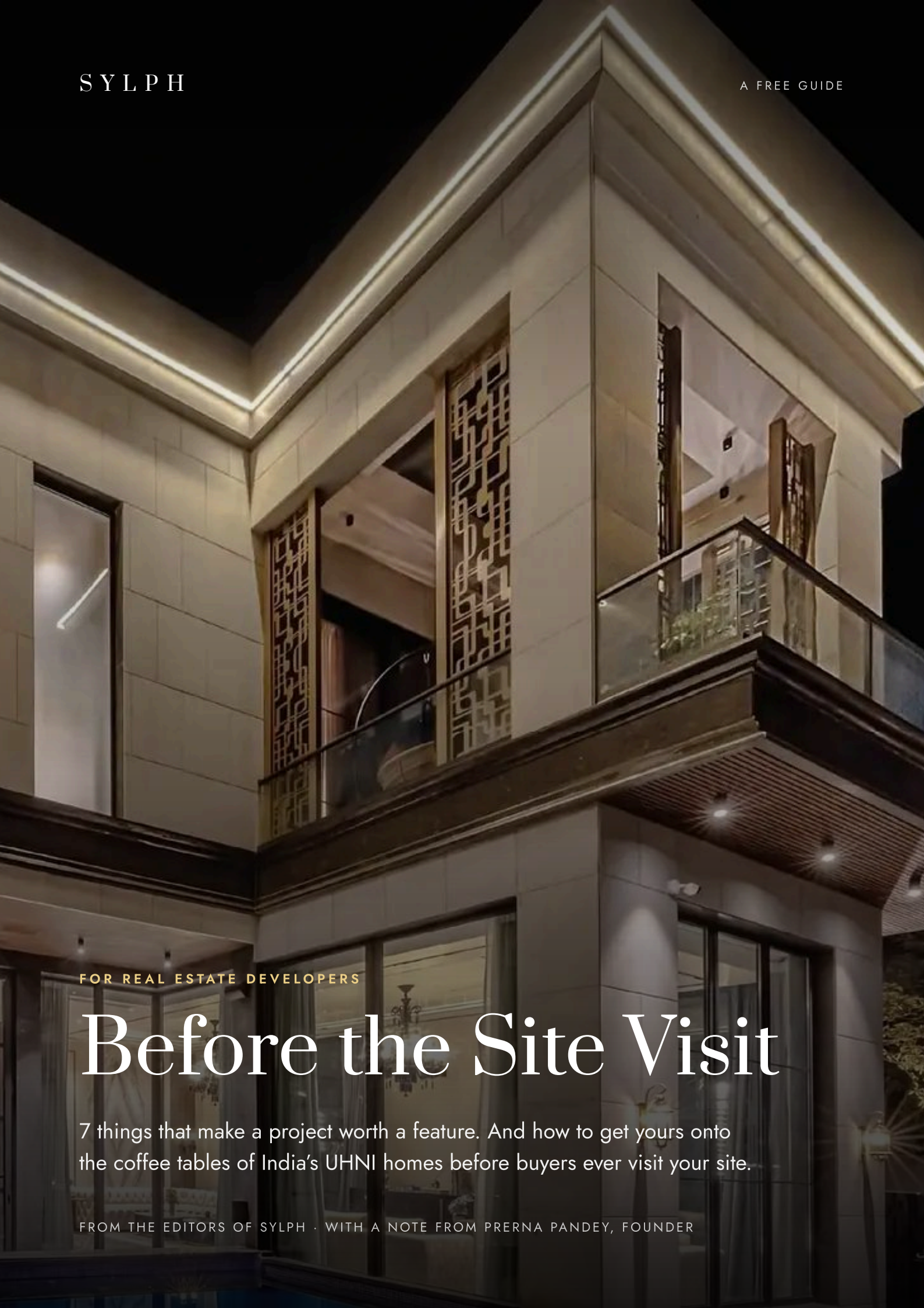


SYLPH

A FREE GUIDE

FOR REAL ESTATE DEVELOPERS

Before the Site Visit

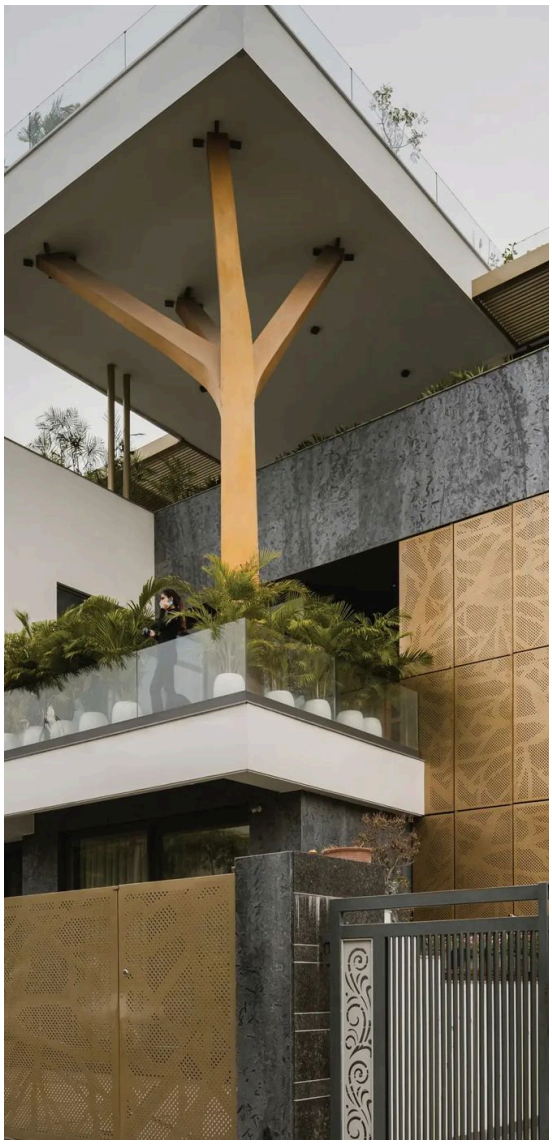
7 things that make a project worth a feature. And how to get yours onto the coffee tables of India's UHNI homes before buyers ever visit your site.

FROM THE EDITORS OF SYLPH · WITH A NOTE FROM PRERNA PANDEY, FOUNDER

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

What you will find

A note from Prerna Pandey	3
Introduction	4
Part One: 7 things that make a project worth a feature	5
Part Two: 5 mistakes that keep good projects out	10
Part Three: 3 things few developers are told	11
The launch checklist	12
Your project in 150 words	13
A year in print	14
What a Sylph project feature looks like	15
Your next step	16



A residence by Varun Garg Architects, from its Sylph feature.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Developers of luxury apartments, villas, commercial and mixed-use projects, and the founders behind them, planning a launch over months, not days.



Prerna Pandey, Founder of Sylph, with the ANCA edition at Wat Chalong Temple, Thailand.

A NOTE FROM THE FOUNDER

Your buyers decide whose name they trust long before the site visit.

Every launch in your city says the same things. Luxury. Exclusive. World-class.

Buyers at this level have heard it all, and believe very little of it.

What they do believe is a story written by an editor, in a magazine they trust, sitting on their own coffee table. That is where the decision about whose name to trust often begins.

This guide shows what makes a project worth that story, and how to prepare yours so it is ready when your launch is.

Prerna Pandey

FOUNDER, SYLPH

INTRODUCTION

Why most launches look the same

Picture a family deciding where to buy their next home. Before they call a single sales office, they have already read about one project, on their own coffee table.

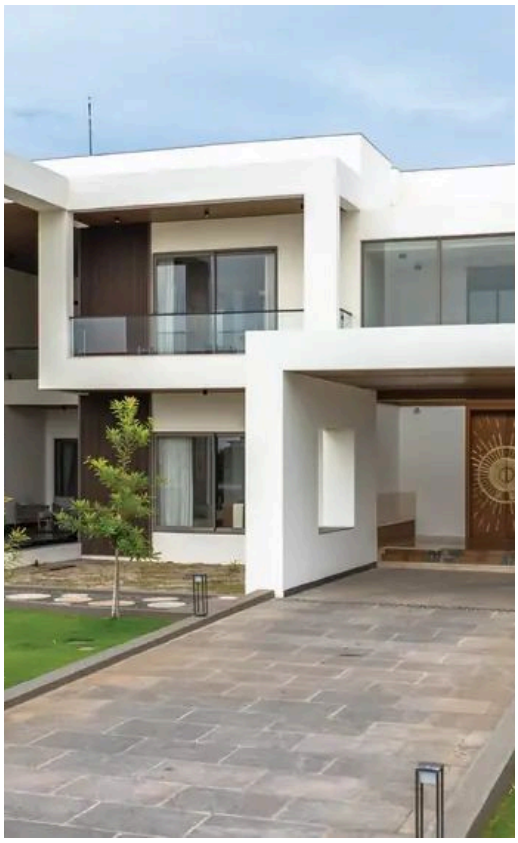
That is what a feature does. It introduces your project and your name in an editor's voice, before the hoardings, the portals and the price-checkers.

But most launches never get that chance. They print brochures that get filed, buy hoardings that look like the next one, and book magazine pages at the last minute, through an agent.

The good news: a project worth a feature is not about the biggest budget. It is about giving an editor a story buyers want to read.

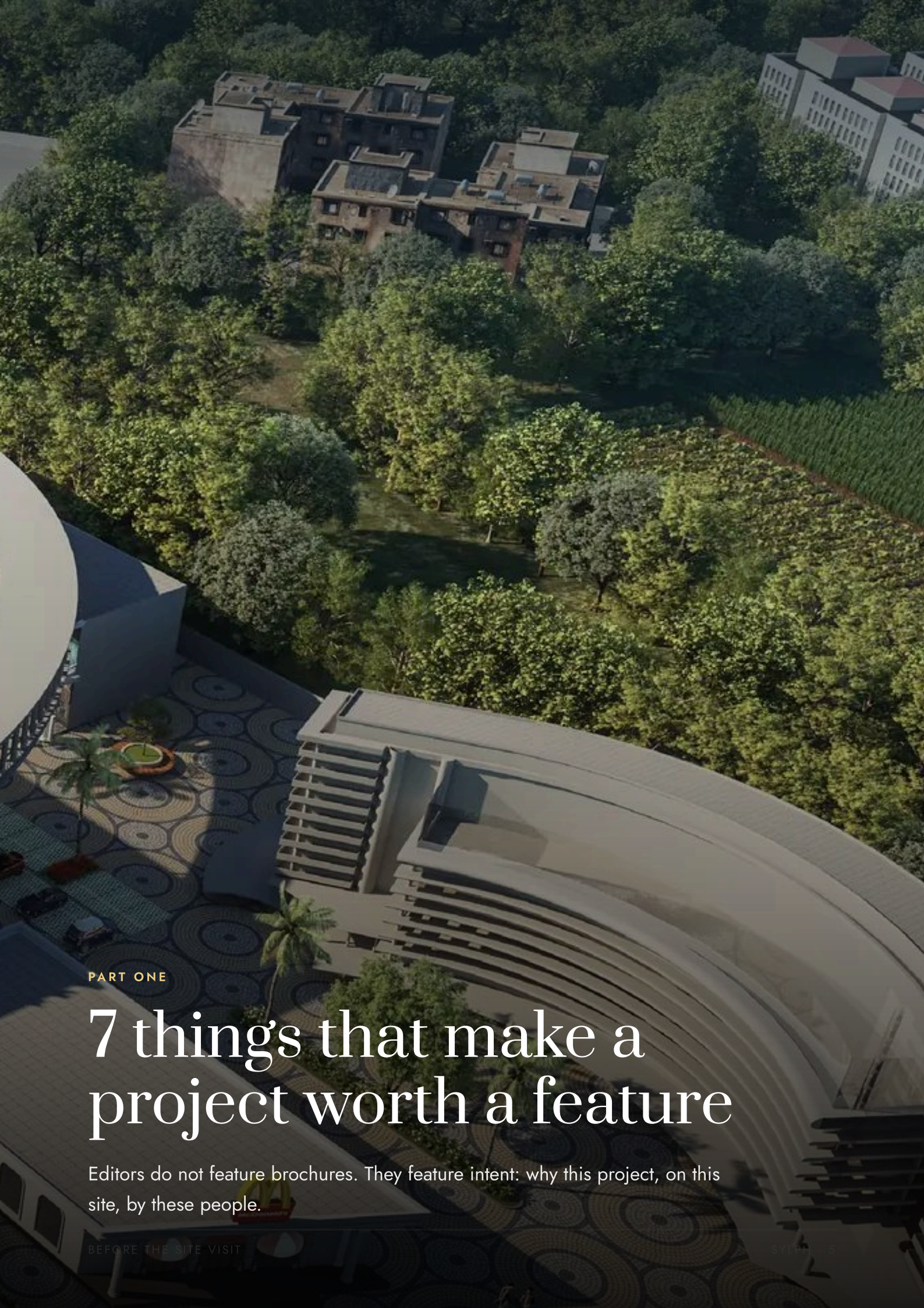
In this guide you will discover:

- ✓ The 7 things that make a project worth a feature
- ✓ The visuals an editor needs, from renders to the founder's portrait
- ✓ The 5 mistakes that keep good projects out
- ✓ How to write your project in 150 words
- ✓ How to plan a year of print around your launch



A home by Inventarchitects, from its Sylph cover story.

48	EDITIONS A YEAR, FOUR A MONTH
60,000+	COPIES A YEAR, HAND-DELIVERED TO UHNI AND HNI HOMES
4	COVERS A MONTH, ONE PER EDITION
7,000+	BRANDS AND STUDIOS SINCE 2021



PART ONE

7 things that make a project worth a feature

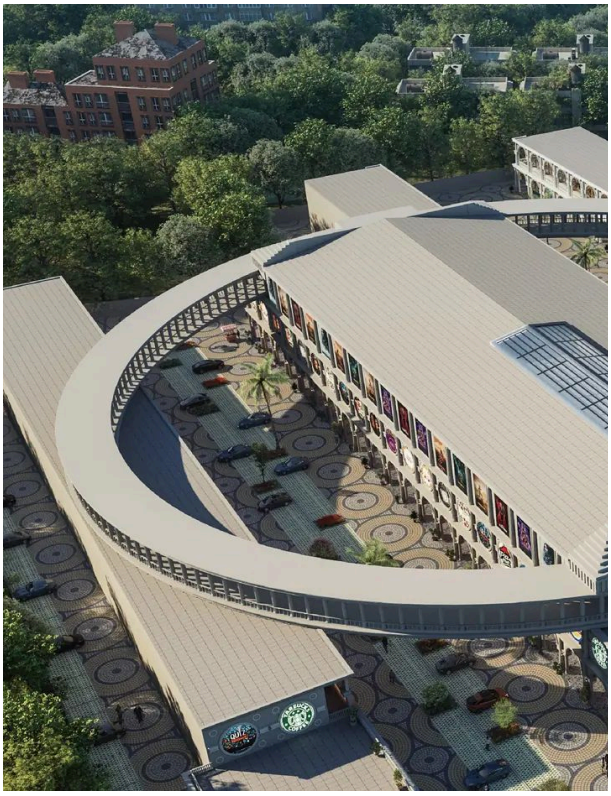
Editors do not feature brochures. They feature intent: why this project, on this site, by these people.

1

The founder's intent

Why did you build this, here, now? What did you refuse to compromise on?

That answer is the start of every good feature. Buyers at this level want to know who is building, and why, before they ask what it costs.



FROM THE PAGES

Varun Garg Architects' feature showed Maya Garden Magnum, a commercial complex set along the Rajpura Ambala Highway, as a single bold idea: a sweeping ring of a building, seen from the air.

2

The site and its story

Every site has a story. The view. The trees that were kept. The street, the neighbourhood, what stood there before.

Tell the editor what makes your land rare. It is the one thing no other project in your city can copy.



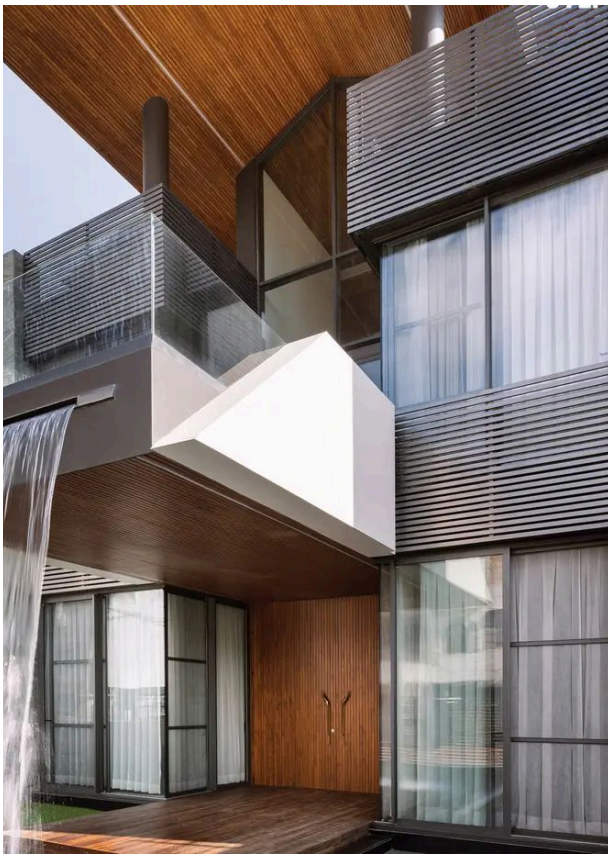
A residence by The Design Unit, from its Sylph feature.

3

The architecture team

Name your architects and designers, and give them room in the story. Their reputation strengthens yours.

A feature that shows the thinking behind the facade, the plan and the materials reads as architecture, not advertising.



Cascade House by Varun Garg Architects, defined by its cascading water curtain. From its Sylph feature.

4

Renders, done right

Before handover, renders are fine. Editors understand. But show the few that matter, not forty.

Label every render clearly. Sylph prints renders as renders, so readers are never misled. And as soon as you have real photographs, of the show apartment, the lobby or the construction, send them too.



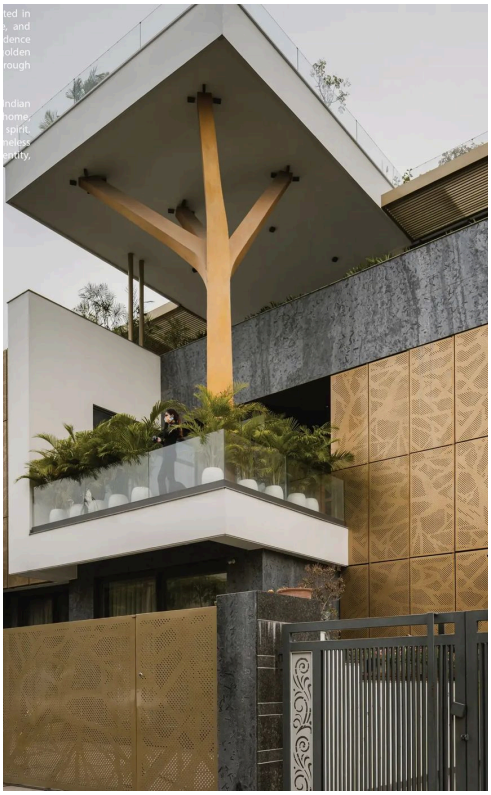
A residence by Inventarchitects, from its Sylph feature.

5

Visuals an editor can actually use

You need 15 to 25 strong visuals, not the whole sales kit. Brief your team with this list.

The hero	One image that tells the whole project in a single frame: a photograph if you have one, a render if you do not.
The site	The land, the view and the neighbourhood, at the best hour of the day.
The architecture	The facade and the arrival, ideally at dusk with the lights on.
The interiors	Two or three key spaces: the show apartment, the lobby, a living room. Renders clearly labelled.
The materials	Close-ups of the stone, the wood and the details buyers will touch.
The team	Your architects and designers, with their permission.
The founder	A portrait of the founder, on site or in a finished space.



A residence by Varun Garg Architects, from its Sylph feature.

BEFORE YOU SEND

- ✓ Send original, full-size files. Images forwarded on WhatsApp lose detail and do not print well.
- ✓ Label every render as a render.
- ✓ Keep claims to what is true today. Editors check.

6

The founder in person

A project is only as trusted as the people behind it. A founder profile puts a face, a history and a set of values to your name.

Have a good portrait ready, and be ready to talk about past projects, and what you learned from them.

Sylph has worked directly with the founder and chairman of one of India's top five real estate developers.



Varun Garg of Varun Garg Architects, on the cover of Sylph.

7

Timing, matched to your launch

Print works on a calendar. Sylph publishes four editions a month, and booked places run first come, first served.

Plan backwards from your launch. Sylph plans launches and milestones to the edition, and pre-launch, launch, construction and handover can each have their own story.

The edition closest to your launch may already be full, so start the conversation months ahead.



A villa by The Design Unit, from its Sylph feature.

PART TWO

5 mistakes that keep good projects out

None of these are about talent. All of them are easy to fix once you know.

---

1 Sending brochure copy

Luxury, exclusive, world-class. Editors cut these words, and so do buyers in their heads. Send facts and a real story instead.

2 Putting the price per square foot in the story

Save it for the sales office. A feature is where buyers decide whether to trust you, not where they compare rates.

3 Forty unlabelled renders

Too many renders, and none of them labelled, make a project look unreal. Send a few strong ones, clearly marked.

4 Booking at the last minute

Places go first come, first served. Developers who call two weeks before launch often find the closest edition already full.

5 Paying an agent for a page

Many magazine pages are sold through agents. A page that costs ₹3 lakh can be sold to you for ₹4.5 lakh, with ₹1.5 lakh kept as the agent's cut. Ask the magazine directly for its fixed price.

PART THREE

3 things few developers are told

NOTE 1

Buyers read about you before they call

At this level, buyers ask friends, advisers and the magazines on their own tables before they ever speak to a sales team. Be in that conversation.

NOTE 2

A feature works hard in the sales office

Keep copies in the sales lounge, share the pages with channel partners, and add them to the launch kit. A third-party story sells better than your own brochure.

NOTE 3

Print builds a name across editions

One feature introduces you. A cover at launch, a founder profile and a project feature through the year build a name buyers remember.



Sylph editions, stacked on a side table.

> "Your brochure tells buyers what you want them to think. A feature tells them what someone else thinks."
>
> SYLPH

USE THIS BEFORE YOU SEND ANYTHING

The launch checklist

Tick every line, and you are ready for an editor. Miss a few, and you know exactly what to fix.

- [ ] I can say why this project exists in one sentence
- [ ] I know what makes this site rare, and I can show it
- [ ] My architects and designers are named, and happy to be featured
- [ ] I have a strong hero image, photograph or clearly labelled render
- [ ] I have visuals of the site, the architecture, key interiors and the materials
- [ ] I have a good portrait of the founder
- [ ] I have the original, full-size files, not WhatsApp copies
- [ ] Every render is clearly labelled as a render
- [ ] There is no “world-class” or price-per-square-foot language in what I send
- [ ] I have written the 150-word story on the next page
- [ ] I know my launch window and the edition closest to it
- [ ] I have planned which story goes in which edition

WORKSHEET

Your project in 150 words

Editors write the story, but they need the facts from you. Fill this in and you have everything they need, in one place.

The project, and its city

Why the founder built it

What makes the site rare

The architects and design team (With permission)

Three materials or details that matter

The stage, and the launch window

Who it is for (Without names)

PLANNING AHEAD

A year in print, around your launch

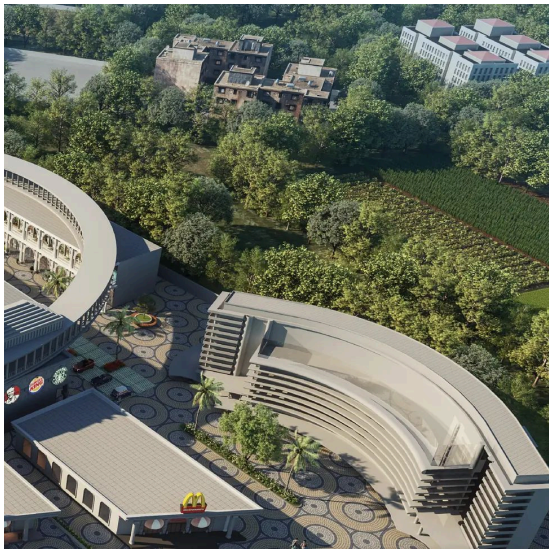
One feature introduces a project. A plan across editions builds a name. Here is one way developers use the year.

Pre-launch	A founder profile. Who you are, what you build, and why buyers can trust the name.
Launch	A cover and the project story inside, in the edition closest to your launch.
Construction	A feature on the architecture, the materials and the progress on site.
Handover	Real photographs of finished spaces. The promise, kept.
In between	Adverts or smaller features to keep the name in front of the same readers.

Sylph's Annual Programme plans 12 to 24 features across the year, edition by edition. The two-minute check shows whether it fits your project.



Ar. Vivek Kumar and Ar. Nanda Devi of Inventarchitects, on the cover of Sylph.



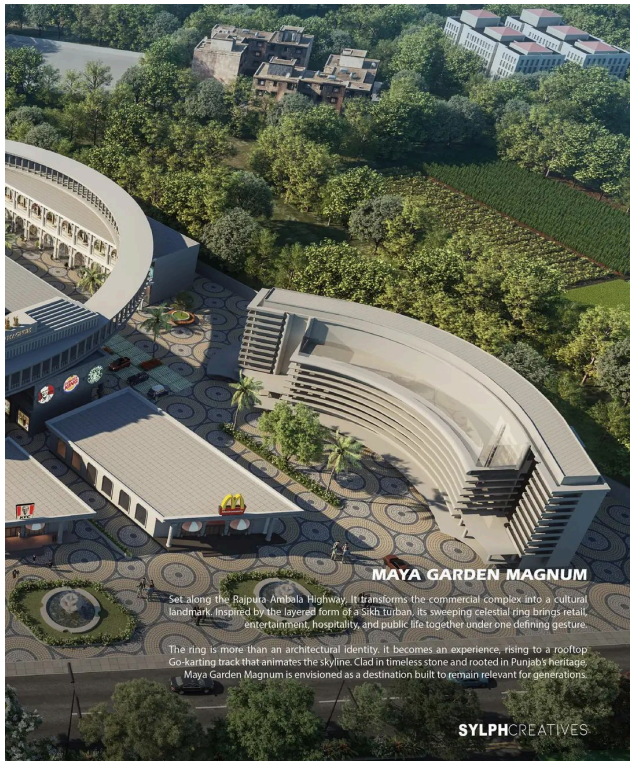
Maya Garden Magnum by Varun Garg Architects, from its Sylph feature.

FROM RECENT EDITIONS

What a Sylph project feature looks like



The cover: Varun Garg Architects.



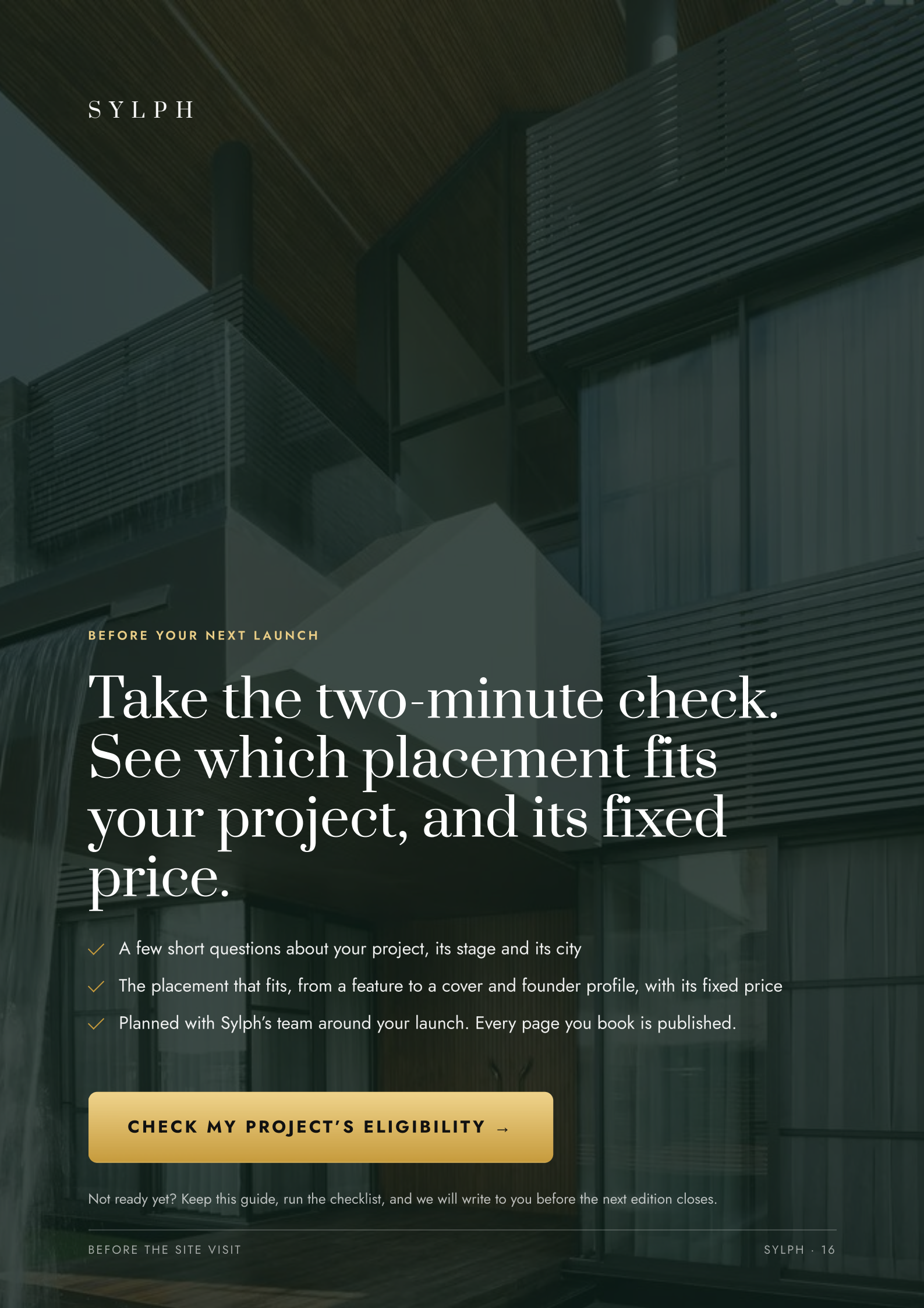
The project: Maya Garden Magnum.



The edition: Sylph × Signature Global.



The interview: Signature Global's Chairman.



SYLPH

BEFORE YOUR NEXT LAUNCH

Take the two-minute check. See which placement fits your project, and its fixed price.

- A few short questions about your project, its stage and its city
- The placement that fits, from a feature to a cover and founder profile, with its fixed price
- Planned with Sylph's team around your launch. Every page you book is published.

CHECK MY PROJECT'S ELIGIBILITY →

Not ready yet? Keep this guide, run the checklist, and we will write to you before the next edition closes.